

BSNL to unveil 5G services in India together with global launch

State-run telecom carrier Bharat Sanchar Nigam Ltd (BSNL) is expected to roll out ultra-high-speed fifth-generation, or 5G, services in tandem with the global launch, as per reports. BSNL is aggressively coordinating with multinational vendors such as Nokia, Coriant and ZTE on a 5G technology roadmap, and aims to unveil enterprise as well as consumer services starting 2020.

Speaking at Mobile Device Summit 2018, organised by The Mobile Association (TMA), Anil Jain, BSNL's chief general man-

ager - new generation networks, said that, BSNL would make the most of the opportunity of the 5G spectrum, although it could not adopt 3G and 4G technologies as per market requirements.

TMA believes, to get the success of 5G technology with telcos, it is important that, before the commercial launch of 5G services, availability of 5G-enabled smartphones is ensured.

BSNL and Japan's technology group have signed a memorandum of understanding (MoU) to collaborate on creating a 5G test bed in India.

India racing to outshine China as world solar power leader

Since its big entry a decade ago, China has led the global solar energy industry. However, India is poised to equal China as a global leader in renewable energy transformation.

According to Institute for Energy Economics and Financial Analysis (IEEFA), half of the world's 10 largest solar parks under construction are in India. India doubled its solar installations to

10GW in 2017-18, and is rapidly scaling up capacity to achieve an ambitious and transformational 100GW of solar power by 2022, Tim Buckley, IEEFA director, said.

Given the land constraints, India's new policy target for 10GW of floating solar parks is a commendable initiative to leverage this innovation to enhance solar power application, the report stated.

World Bank approves ₹ 20.4 bn aid for India's energy-efficiency programme

World Bank has approved a ₹ 20.4 billion (US\$ 300 million) aid package to help scale up India's energy-efficiency programme. This includes ₹ 14.96 billion in the form of a loan and an additional ₹ 5.44 billion as guarantees for projects, reported *ETEnergyworld*.

To be implemented by Energy Efficiency Services Ltd (EESL), the programme will help scale up deployment of energy-saving measures in residential and public sectors, strengthen EESL's institutional capacity and enhance its access to commercial financing.

On The Move

BEL appoints Mahesh V as director - R&D

Mahesh V has taken charge as director - R&D of Navratna Defence PSU Bharat Electronics Ltd (BEL). He was working as executive director - technology planning at BEL's corporate office before his elevation. Mahesh joined BEL, Bengaluru in March 1985 after completing his BE (electronics) from R.V. College of Engineering, Bengaluru. His first assignment at BEL was the development of telemetry systems and control systems for antennae tracking of launch vehicles and timing systems for Indian Space Programme, in association with ISRO.

Amit Doshi appointed CMO, Lenovo India

Lenovo India has appointed Amit Doshi as chief marketing officer (CMO). Doshi will report to Bhaskar Choudhuri, who is moving on to Lenovo Asia Pacific as CMO. Doshi will be responsible for strengthening the Lenovo brand in India and South Asia to enable profitable growth across all business segments, namely, consumer, enterprise and SMB. He will focus on deepening digital and data competencies towards building a more customer-centric organisation.

Tata Motors hires Shailesh Chandra as EV vertical head

Tata Motors Ltd has created an electric mobility business vertical and appointed Shailesh Chandra as president. Chandra has played an instrumental role in leading the project teams to deliver the electric variant of the compact sedan Tigor to Energy Efficiency Services Ltd (EESL), the state-owned firm that will procure and lease electric vehicles (EVs) to central and state governments.

Samsung Electronics hires two AI scientists

Samsung Electronics has hired renowned artificial intelligence (AI) scientists, to find new opportunities to strengthen and upgrade its AI technology. Dr H. Sebastian Seung, professor at Neuroscience Institute and Department of Computer Science at Princeton University, and Dr Daniel D. Lee, UPS Foundation Chair Professor at School of Engineering and Applied Science at University of Pennsylvania, will help improve company's global AI R&D capabilities.